



Soil is Alive!



Soil is one of the most important things in an ecosystem. That's right. Soil is not just the dirt under our feet. Life underground is just as important as life above ground. In the soil, there is an intricate food web on the go.

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Soil is made up of some important parts. Soil includes rock materials, microorganisms, parts of dead plants and animals, water, and air. Soil can take hundreds or even thousands of years to form.

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The best kind of soil to grow food in, is called loam. Loam is made of sand, silt and clay. Loam allows air and water to flow through it with ease.

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What goes on in the soil is complex. Underground, plants and their roots offer food and nutrients for bacteria and microorganisms in the soil. Plants need the food web in the soil to give them the nutrients that they live on.

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Creatures like earthworms and millipedes then eat these microscopic organisms. Underground dwellers eat dead and decaying organic matter (of both animals and plants) that have made their way down to the soil.

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Near the top of the food web, these smaller soil creatures are eaten by even bigger animals, like moles and mice.

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By understanding the soil food web, we can see that plants could not grow and live without it. And without the soil, animals and humans would not have food.

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